

How People Use Photography and Graphic Design as a Weapon Against War and Conflict.

BY

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Intro to Research Methods

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Introduction

“One advantage of photography is that it's visual and can transcend language
“(Lisa Kristine). Photography is a great instrument for social change that allows individuals to document their circumstances, share their stories, and change their lives. Photography and the use of images adds depth and forwards the social exploration and commentary on issues impacting our society.

When we are talking about photography we need to talk about photojournalism. Photojournalism is the method of creating news articles utilizing mainly photographs. Photojournalism is what makes news powerful and heartbreaking, so people take action to help victims of violence. The one click is all it takes to make a video or a picture that helps people to understand what is being done to someone elsewhere in the world. Feidin Santana said about the South Carolina shooting: “I told them what they did was an abuse” (Almasy). The video that was captured by Feidin showed the violence that police had been involved. The video showed the power of photography fighting against violence. As Feiden's video plays a vital role in the society to fight against violence; the heartbreaking picture of a dead refugee baby on a Turkish beach in September last year played also did. The body of the little boy, still dressed in bright red T-shirt and shorts, was found lying face-down in the surf on the beach near the resort town of Bodrum, 400km west of the city of Antalya on Turkey's idyllic Turquoise Coast. Not only was his humanity washed ashore, but it gives the idea of what will happen to other children who are same age as him (Bloch).

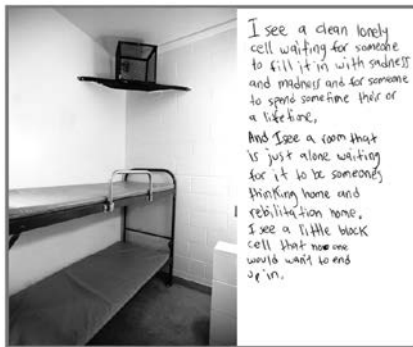


Courtesy of npr.org

Similar technique to photojournalism, portrait photography is the great example to show emotions, for example, fear, hidden truth, violence and crime victims. Fear was what we have experienced when we had to live inside the iron fence. We all have fear that if we show our face to the camera, local people will recognize us and then treat us badly. On the other hand, who doesn't like to be in front of a camera at first? For the first time, we Bhutanese refugee boys stood against fear, when U.N. people come to make a documentary about us. While they captured our faces on film, we still showed our fear in the picture. Those pictures helped to show the hidden truth about how local people treated us. One click of the camera totally changed our life; that one click helped to fight against violence and crime which was done to us. We always hid ourselves and never told we were the victims until we stood up in front of the camera when U.N. People came to our refugee camp in Nepal on 2005. Those pictures they captured of us helped to get to America. This is why portrait photography helps to fight against violence and help to never hide problems.

Today anybody can buy justice if they are rich; justice becomes business to the rich and justice remains injustice to poor people. This is why there is photojournalism, which helps to treat people equally. Photojournalism helps to provide justice over

injustice to people. It helps poor people to label injustice and win it over; it helps victims to get an idea what justice feels like “Juvenile in Justice” reads. “Richard Ross' photographs provide educational and cultural connection to thousands of Americans behind bars” (Sekoff). This is what photojournalism does.



I see a clean lonely
cell waiting for someone
to fill it in with sadness
and madness and for someone
to spend some time their or
a lifetime,
And I see a room that
is just alone waiting
for it to be someone's
thinking home and
rehabilitation home,
I see a little black
cell that no one
would want to end
up in.

Courtesy of huffingtonpost.com

Photojournalism and portrait photography are the full potential of the art of photography that will change everything. Violence can happen to anyone and can occur in many different situations, all over the world. No matter how violence is applied, it is unacceptable to abuse people. Photojournalism and portrait photography work will always stand against violence. As we all know photography is a collection of images that visualize the truth, illustrate how violence is occurring and what steps we have to take against violence. So, photography is aware or tells details on what is going on through graphically appealing and giving opportunity to focus the viewer on what the

photograph is about. Whereas there is another form of photography that is graphic design. Graphic design shows the evidence of what is going on all over the world, when a photographer can't go there and take the real evidence. In other word, it is the way to show real things by graphing the photo that is not really happened where it was captured but happened in another part of world. A photographer and graphic of it summarizes the entire issue that happened and illustrates the essential solution through their one-click device.

Photojournalism

Photojournalism doesn't demonstrate "life". It doesn't have time to understand or the space to display its complexity. The photos we find in our daily papers demonstrate solidified moments taken outside of any relevant connection to the issue at hand and put on a stage of the media's making, then sold as truth. In any case, if the photographer shot the movement of war, it is good to see how the photographer tells the story within the photographs. Also, what does that make him or her, a patriot or fear trader? From the photojournalist, we'll never know since time is of the embodiment, and a due date dependably lingers. Viewers can be left with a one-sided viewpoint, deserted to make up their psyches in view of fragmented evidence.

Photojournalism started and emerged around the world in 1853. Carol Szathmari, a Romanian painter and photographer who documented the Crimean War, introduced it. Crimean war was the battle between Russia and Turkey from 1853 to 1856. Carol Szathmari shows the living style of the both countries troop and shows the world that war isn't good. Today his photos may strike viewers as to a great extent unexciting activities in scene and portraiture. Pictures of warriors, weaponry, camp and

fight locales, and war-harmed structures and strongholds flourish. There are no shots of fight activities, the sort of pictures we have generally expected from war settings, which were then difficult to take. Most of Carol photographs do not exist today but some of them do. One of many exist photograph is the “Romanian battery on the banks of the Danube 1877.” The photograph is blurry but show that reality of what was going on at that time period (Carol Szathmari).



Courtesy of monoskop.org

Carol has become the role model the many photographers including Mathew Brady. Mathew use Carol's work and technique in the American Civil War. Mathew Brady's documentation of the Civil War earned him a place in photojournalism history. The celebrated 19th century American photographer brought his photo studio right on the battlefields. Some of his most memorable shots were taken at the First Battle of Bull Run, in which Brady reportedly got so close to the action that he was almost captured by the enemy. The celebration of the 19th century American photography lead him to shoot photographs in the battlefields. His work of the Civil War earned him a place in the photojournalism history. But he was almost captured by enemy when he was taking shots at the First Battle of Bull Run due to facts when he got close to the action.



Courtesy of image.google.com

I think he was almost captured by the enemy due to facts he was showing the reality and the enemy doesn't like that Mathew was using photography to end the war. That lead him to show more of what was going on the battle field; he took his traveling darkroom to the Battle of Antietam. At the Battle of Antietam, he documented the travesties of war, including graphic photographs of corpses. He took the graphic photographs of corpses to show how deadly the war was. Brady's photographs furnished numerous Americans with their first perspective of the realities of war in photos versus "artist impressions." Brady's work was considered the most important visual documentation of the Civil War that let us to know what was happened at that time and why we care about the Civil War (Trust).

From another perspective comes Jacob August Riis, a Danish photographer. He is credited with utilizing his photographic and journalistic gifts to help the poorest of poor people. Riis most productive pictures were the subject of New York City's slums and their impoverished residents. His photographs also become the primary subjects lit by a new type of flash Riis utilized on his box cameras. Riis worked in New York's most crime-ridden and ruined slums in the dark of night as a police columnist for a local newspaper. He worked in order to change the environment of New York and make it a

safer place. Riis used the flash in order to capture stark indoor and outdoor night scenes. The photographs he brought to the public's eye were the stunning pictures of the city's poor full of crowded tenements. His photographs appeared in books, newspapers and magazines to use as a tools for social reform. In 1890, he even published book a named "How the Other Half Lives". His book was about social criticism and its pages showed the reader about how New York people lived and experienced bad things in the country of freedom to do anything (Bio.com).



Courtesy of Bio.com

It is clear that Jacob August Riis wanted to show the livelihood of New York people. Likewise, Jacob, similarly, Margaret Bourke-White showed how the livelihood of people was during World War II. She made a history by becoming the world's first female war reporter. Most of the American photojournalists worked for the companies like *Fortune* and *Life* magazines covering battle zones in Germany, Africa and Italy amid World War II. Among American photojournalists, Bourke-White was also the main American photographer in Russia during the battle of Moscow. Moreover, she captured the drought casualties of the Dust Bowl, the survivors of the Buchenwald concentration camp, and Gandhi a couple of hours before his death.



Courtesy of image.google.com

She is viewed as a legend in the field of photojournalism and her honor winning pictures can be found in museums around different countries (Encyclopaedia Britannica).

In the modern-day photojournalism became the pioneer to show what is going on or how people in devastate movement. It became the source of reporting real life. Henri Cartier-Bresson, the French photojournalist, was the mater of candid photography. He created “street photography” or “real life reporting,” which records minute of human details. Henri is credited with the father of modern photojournalism. He also made five movies that are real life story, the most notable one is *The Return* (1945).



Courtesy of image.google.com

He follows prisoners of war returning home from Germany to their respective countries so show how difficult it was to live as prisoners and to show the environment of the prison. He himself had spent nearly three years as a prisoner of war when he was enlisted in the army in 1939. Cartier-Bresson's style of photography has shaped eras of modern

day photojournalists. His work, most prominently his remarkable pictures of world leaders, has yet to be outperformed (Rountree).

Photojournalism today is based on photography and graphic design. Photography in graphic design is critical in light of the fact that its utilization is exceptionally reference graphic. When the designers utilize the photograph, they try to catch viewer attention. The photograph in graphic design is the primary concern; the photograph will reflect the message that designer wants to show. On the other hand, a photograph must be hypothetical and exploratory in the case of the photograph as a symphonious composition that allows viewers to interact with the design. In the 1920s and 30s a host of unpredictable structures and methods suddenly flourished. Unique photograms, photomontages made out of divided pictures using the combination of photographs with modern typography and graphic design in posters and magazine pages. All of these are the aspects artist and theorist László Moholy-Nagy (1895–1946) eagerly portrayed as "new vision" established in the innovative culture of the twentieth century (The New Vision).

Portrait photography

As I have already mentioned that portrait photography is the great example to show emotions, for example, fear, hidden truth, violence and crime victims. It is true that someone might hid the truth and reality, but portrait of that someone will show what the truth was hidden. Unlike other forms of photography, the subjects of portrait photography can be anyone. This means that ordinary people are mostly subject in a portrait. This is why portrait photography speaks truth about what is going to that person. If someone knows the fear of why that person is hiding the truth, it will be easy

to find the solution. In the other word, portrait photography is the art of capturing a people's facial features as well as facial expressions are made predominantly. Portrait photography might surprise the world by showing the horrible event on the portrait through the facial expressions of people. Sometime it might shock by showing the dead body of actual event happening. Such as, *The Death of Antietam* by Mathew Brady.

Although Mathew Brady was best known for his photojournalism of the Civil War, he also became successful as a portrait photographer. A lot of his friends tried to discourage to go into the battlefield and take photographs, but he didn't stop. I love what he said later when he went to capture battlefield portrait. He said, "I felt that I had to go. A spirit in my feet said 'Go,' and I went." This why photographer like Mathew and other didn't care what will happen to them, they care about who will do it or change it if they don't. This is why in 1862, Mathew Brady shocked America by displaying Alexander Gardner's and James Gibson's photographs of battlefield corpses from Antietam.



Courtesy of image.google.com

This exhibition marked the first time most people witnessed the carnage of war. His photographs of battlefield corpses from Antietam give information about what was the living style of people and soldiers during the battle of Antietam ("Civil War Glass

Negatives and Related Prints - Mathew B. Brady - Biographical Note - Prints & Photographs Online Catalog (library of Congress)").

It was clear that portrait photography leads the world against war. Photographer James Nachtwey was inspired by Images from the Vietnam War and the American civil rights movement to become a photographer. And he and his photography became my inspiration to be a photographer. James Nachtwey covered conflicts and major social issues in more than 30 countries. Some of the countries he covered were, El Salvador, Nicaragua, Guatemala, Lebanon, the West Bank and Gaza, Israel, Indonesia, Thailand, India, Sri Lanka, Afghanistan, the Philippines, South Korea, Somalia, Sudan, Rwanda, South Africa, Russia, Bosnia, Chechnya, Kosovo, Romania, Brazil, and the United States. Here, he talks about all the conflicts and tragedies he covered in the last four decades. Such as a man who had just been liberated from a Hutu concentration camp.



Courtesy of jamesnachtwey.com

He even captured the civil strife in Northern Ireland in 1981 during the IRA hunger strike during his first foreign assignment. IRA hunger was what made him devote himself to documenting wars, conflicts, and critical social issues (Society).

Eye, heart and mind are the key factors for Carol Guzy when she takes photographs. She isn't afraid to go and see what is happening. "US troops occupied

Haiti to restore order after a military coup. Guzy was covering a pro-democracy march when a grenade went off. "The mob was about to tear apart the man they thought had thrown the grenade," she says. "The soldier had pulled him out and definitely saved his life. I had fallen to the ground and got this shot looking up at the action." It is clear that people doesn't like war or any kind of fighting. Her photograph of that soldier allowed us to know that war creates war not peace.



Courtesy of Washingtonian.com

If the war creates peace, why people fight against the people. Even though he was a soldier, he knows what is the meaning of humanity and save a suspect from the crowd after an explosive device is thrown during a pro-democracy march in Haiti (Jaffe).

As Carol Guzy showed the meaning of humanity; there is Lynsey Addario captured many photographs in different places to make sure what humanity means. Lynsey Addario's famous work were: "reportage on Syrian refugees for The New York Times, the ISIS push into Iraq, the civil war in South Sudan, and maternal mortality in Sierra Leone for Time." She released a New York Times best-selling memoir, *It's What I Do*, which chronicles her life as a photojournalist coming of age in the post-9/11 world." *On It's What I Do*, she showed the truth of war that is against peace. It was shocked by the truth of war, which is against peace. So, war is against peace, why US has always said that we will make a peace by bombing civilian (Lynsey Addario).

Lynsey Addario covered India, Afghanistan under Taliban rule, Pakistan, and Nepal before September 11, 2001 in the Associated Press, the Boston Globe, and the

Houston Chronicle. After the events of September 11, 2001, she covered the women's educational issues that were affected by war in Afghanistan. Her work showed what is the life and living style of Sudanese refugee camps in Chad. As a woman, she captured the women's issues in Saudi Arabia, Turkey, Libya, South Africa, and Lebanon and showed through her photographs. She even shows the reality of "infant mortality, juvenile justice, sexual assault of minors, malnutrition, and education in countries across Africa for the New York Times" (NatGeo).



Courtesy of lynseyaddario.com

Portrait photography played important role on political role. It helps to decide whether they might go to war or fight against the war. Same as portrait, its graphic also played important political role in the early 20th century, as seen in poster below and other graphic propaganda produced during World War I. "Colour printing had advanced to a high level, and governments used poster designs to raise funds for the war effort." Such as portrait of army recruiting poster featuring "Uncle Sam."



Courtesy of www.britannica.com

It is true that poster of army recruiting is helpful to recruit more people to go to war. But on the other side also help more people to know why the poster like army recruiting poster featuring “Uncle Sam” was designed. It was clear that designed was just to create war out of war, but it also helps people like us to fight against war. It helps to fight against war simply the fact that we have seen so many photographs of war that aren’t good and they are emotional attach than an army recruiting poster. The army recruiting poster doesn’t only help us to know war isn’t for peace, but help to know that army doesn’t view civilian as people in the war zone. They don’t view civilian as people due to the fact army recruiting poster doesn’t have respectful manner (Encyclopædia Britannica).

Social Justice

It is true and real if there is no justice, there will be no peace. This is why people like Lynsey Addario go to different places and captured the photographs of innocent people in order to provide them justice. If the existing structures of any organization or governance cannot provide justice for anyone, then those structures must be pushed aside or there will be no peace. This means that social justice is the ideas of equality or equal opportunity in society. We know that if there is no justice there is no peace. On the other side if is no peace, there is war. War basically happens if there is no justice and if they can’t have pushed the existing structures of any organization or governance aside. But there is photography and graphic design which will show the reality and provide the justice to injustice people. It doesn’t only give justice to them, but make sure there is peace and good structures of any organization or governance.

As we all know that photography fight for the right and justice. It doesn't just fight for justice by showing different photographs, it gives us a message about what will happen if it happened here in America. We as an American, drink clean water, wash everything with clean water that make me feel angry and sorrow to those who drink dirty water. Water is the most important thing in our life, but something some people didn't have enough and clean water. There is photography that will lead these people to have clean water and safe water.



Courtesy of pulitzercenter.org

As you can see in the “Pumps, But No Pipes” photograph that boys are drinking and washing the unsafe and dirty water. In Wadata, a neighborhood in Makurdi, Nigeria, water comes from the Benue river. The pump feeds the hose floats on the river, amid garbage and human waste. But the people of Makurdi filled the yellow jugs in the Benue river and then sold as clean in the town. Imagine if you were the people of that place who aren't educated enough to know or they have no choice to drink other than dirty water. We used to drink the same kind of water but less polluted in refugee camp and know how that photographs make us feel. It is not just we was uneducated; it is what we have to drink in order to be alive. “Pumps, But No Pipes” not only fight for the clean water justice, but also help other place to make sure they all get clean water and fight against the government who doesn't do nothing to them (Pulitzer Center).

Water isn't just a problem that government doesn't do anything. There are many people who doesn't know or have social justice. Marriage is the biggest problem in the societies around the world. If you travel the poorest countries, you can find that many children were married. This not only the problem, but they are forced to get married. They forced due to facts their parents get a loan or money from the person who they are married. Most of the children try to seek the justice, but government or some organization doesn't help. They didn't get justice due to the fact marriage in young is illegal and are not registered in court. Child marriage exists in more than fifty developing countries, including Yemen also. "Nujood Ali's courageous act of seeking a divorce is part of what inspired Stephanie Sinclair to travel to Yemen for her child marriage project." Nujood Ali was 10 when she fled her abusive, much older husband and took a taxi to the courthouse in Sanaa, Yemen. The girl's courageous act and the landmark legal battle ensued and turned her into an international heroine to women's right. Nujood Ali story leads Stephanie Sinclair to start project call "Too Young to Wed" which is basically seeking justice for children and end child marriage with the help of camera's one click. "Nujood is pictured here with her younger sisters a few years after her divorce" (Society).



Courtesy of wovexhibition.org

Global demand for fast fashion only benefits the richer in America and Europe. But it is expense to poor, uneducated workers who live at the lower end of the supply chain. The photograph below is basically about social justice for the global goods, local cost. Many of the people works under a dollar a day to feed the family and the

government doesn't care about it. But many of the companies like Walmart, Kmart and so on care about those who are poor in order to get profit from them. One the poorest country Bangladesh is suffering from it and you can see in the photograph. The photograph is about "Rashida Begum and her husband, Azad, wait outside the DNA lab in Dhaka in hopes of a positive genetic match confirming their daughter's death." They don't have choice other than take their daughter death body and there is no charge for the murder of their daughter.



Courtesy of vqronline.org

The photograph captured by Jason Motlagh in order to provide the justice to those who suffer from the foreign companies and their government. "In Bangladesh, one year after the worst accident in the history of the garment industry, recovery remains a fragile process, justice seems elusive, and reform has a long way to go." More than 1,100 poorly paid garment workers died on May 2014, when the eight story collapsed. Retailers in America and Europe who profit from cheap Bangladeshi labor have reverted to business as usual. So this is why Jason Motlagh want us to know what we are wearing and how much it costs. It is not the costs, which we buy, but the costs of the life of the worker (Jason Motlagh).

Conclusion

Photography is the best way for social change that allows all of us to document our stories and lives as some of them show in past. Photography had changed the many

lives through its different part such as portrait photography and photojournalism. It could change the world and destroy the enemy without using gun and bombs that we are used to kill enemies in Middle East.

At the same time, some of the photographers use photography to help and protect refugees as someone use to help when I was living in Camp. There are only a few people who take risks to help someone and save their life. But on the other hand there are some terrorists who use photography to increase the violence and destroy the justice. But violence doesn't stay long enough if we have people like Carol Szathmari, Mathew B. Brady, Jacob August Riis, Margaret Bourke-White, and Henri Cartier-Bresson. These people and photographers hope to support humanity.

The use of photography in war is to not just to show what is going on but to predict what will be happening next. But some of the photographer can't show visually while taking picture at the war field because the outcome of war can be different. Most of the time photojournalism and portrait photography are used to help the condition of people living in war zones and give justice to them and also end injustice. Modern photojournalism uses the graphic elements to show the real event or thing happening now. They use it in a sense of helping people and giving information about the event.

Portrait photography helps me to understand what is the change and how we can change the worst to good. The Portrait photographs of battlefield corpses from Antietam, fall of the Berlin Wall, IRA hunger strike, pro-democracy march and Sudanese refugee are the key factor that I believe there is a need of change but change will start by the one click of a camera. Those photographs also give me a chance to know that war isn't good and good isn't bad unless we make sure to make good.

Social justice will never happen if people doesn't start to show the real situation of the place. Those photographs of boy's drinking dirty water, Too Young to Wed and global goods, local cost are the some of the examples to make sure every will get social justice. Those photographs are an inspiration to me in order to take photographs. When I finish the college, I am planning to travel different countries than teach photography and graphic design. My hope is to make sure every poor and refugee will have some knowledge about the change, photography and graphic design wherever I go.

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